

it is the Pakistan Army establishment as a whole. We have not pushed this fact with the Americans. The basic problem is we do not wield leverage with the Pakistan Army. We have to use countries who do.

Lt-Gen. (retd) Satish Nambiar: The measures that have been taken, like changing the home minister, are cosmetic. I advocated surgical strikes when the Parliament was attacked but in this particular instance, I don't think it would be appropriate as we have been able to carry the international community with us. At that point, it would have made sense if we had done it within ten hours of the Parliament attack taking place. But I don't think we were even clear in those ten hours if Pakistan was behind it. Kasab and his interrogation came much later. Mumbai wasn't a case for a surgical strike. Our capacity to carry out surgical strikes exists but I don't think the armed forces are ready. We are lucky because no one has tested us in recent years but the Pakistanis are even less ready.

Ajit Doval: Mumbai was a covert operation by an adversary which did not start at 9.30 p.m. on 26/11. It began in February 2008 with the arrest of Rahim Ansari from whom the maps were recovered and the hotels identified. The routes were indicated and in his interrogation he had said a Lashkar contingent had been prepared for India. We did not act on this. Tactically, our response was inadequate. The police was ill-equipped, movements disorganised as there was no contingency plan and they did not have good communications. Obviously, coordination at the policy level was missing and non-focussed. No media in any other country would have been so irresponsible to the extent of complicating things for the agencies. It was only because of television that the terrorists were able to see what was going on.

Post-event also, the country is no better to handle a situation like that because we have not been able to solve the fundamental shortcomings. Creating the National Investigating Agency (NIA) to fight terrorism is

BRAHMA CHELLANEY



Between inaction and strikes lie a hundred economic, political and diplomatic options, which we have not used.

Counter-terror strategy needs a well thought-out doctrine, effective instruments, a deterrent structure and political resolve.

The Indian Government is too afraid to even raise the question of covert strikes.

India has suffered more major terror strikes than any other nation but we don't have a counter-terror doctrine.

At the highest level of the Government, there is this desire to discuss but not to take any hard decisions.

KIRAN BEDI

The police leadership today is quiet, is crying, is helpless and is weak and leaderless.

No systemic corrections have been done since 26/11. No one in the Home Ministry has paid the price.



India's 1.3 million policemen have not been made a part of the war on terror.

The invisible occupation by bureaucrats who control police budgets and postings takes the courage out of the force.

Anti-terrorist cells in every state must be assured of funds, of intelligence budgets and mobility.